

Knee Exercises for Seniors - Printable Pack

From *Knee Exercises for Seniors* by Margaret Hale (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The 8-Week Tracker

A tick for the daily routine, an A or a B for a strength session, the minutes for a walk, and the knee's score out of ten the next morning.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Next-morning knee (0 to 10)
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								

The Test Sheet

Test	Before Week 1 (date)	After Week 4 (date)	After Week 8 (date)	3 months later
30-second chair stand (number of stands; note "with hands" if used)				
Timed up and go (seconds; note "with stick" if used)				
Pain going down one flight of stairs (0 to 10)				
The bend: heel to buttock distance, lying (cm), or "under the chair: yes / no"				
My normal range for my age (chair stand, from Chapter 4)				

The 30-second chair stand: normal range by age (the middle half of healthy people)

Age	Women (number of stands)	Men (number of stands)
60 to 64	12 to 17	14 to 19
65 to 69	11 to 16	12 to 18
70 to 74	10 to 15	12 to 17
75 to 79	10 to 15	11 to 17
80 to 84	9 to 14	10 to 15
85 to 89	8 to 13	8 to 14
90 to 94	4 to 11	7 to 12

Timed up and go: under 10 seconds is normal; 10 to 14 is worth improving; over about 13.5 goes with a raised risk of falls (tell the doctor).

The Pain Rule Card

During the exercise	What to do
0 to 2 out of 10	Carry on; when it is easy, do more
3 to 5	Acceptable, if the knee is back to normal by the next morning
6 or more, or sharp, catching, stabbing	Stop that exercise; the easier version, or leave it out
The next morning	
Same or better than yesterday morning	The session was right
Worse: more pain, swelling or stiffness	The session was too much: fewer repetitions, the easier version, no weight next time
See a doctor	Hot, red, swollen knee or fever; a hot swollen tender calf (same day); a knee that locks or gives way; cannot take weight; pain every night; numbness down the leg

My Precautions

Condition or operation, and date	
Exercises or movements to avoid	
The bend allowed (degrees or "no limit")	
Kneeling allowed from	
Medicines that matter (blood thinners, blood pressure)	
Who to call, and the number	

The 10-Minute Daily Routine

	Exercise	Dose
1	Ankle pumps	20, and 10 circles each way
2	Seated heel slides	10 each leg
3	Static quads	Hold 5 s, 10 each leg
4	Seated knee extension	8 to 12 each leg
5	Seated marching	20 each leg
6	Seated hamstring curl	Hold 5 s, 10 each leg
7	Cushion squeeze	Hold 5 s, 10
8	Knee push-out	Hold 5 s, 10
9	Seated heel raise	15
10	Sit to stand	5 to 10

Session A (standing)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	Daily routine 1 to 5, or a 5-minute walk	
1	Sit to stand	8 to 10, 2 sets
2	Mini squat	8 to 12, 2 sets
3	Step-up	8 to 12 each leg, 2 sets
4	Controlled step-down (from Week 5)	8 to 10 each leg, 2 sets
5	Standing side leg raise	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
6	Standing hamstring curl	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
7	Standing heel raises	15, 2 sets
8	Single-leg stand	10 to 30 s each leg, 3 times
Stretch	Hamstring, calf, quad	30 s each, twice

Session B (lying down)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	Daily routine 1 to 5, or a 5-minute walk	
1	Straight leg raise	8 to 12 each leg, 2 sets
2	Short-arc quads	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
3	Bridge	8 to 12, 2 sets
4	Side-lying leg raise	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
5	Clamshell	12 to 15 each side, 2 sets
6	Inner thigh lift	10 to 15 each leg, 2 sets
7	Wall slide	Hold 5 to 15 s, 5 times
8	Terminal knee extension with a band (from Week 5)	15 each leg, 2 sets
Stretch	Knee to chest, hip flexor, outer hip	30 s each, twice

The Flare Routine

	What	How often
1	Ice, 20 minutes, the leg up	3 times a day
2	Ankle pumps	20, every hour you are sitting
3	Static quads	Hold 5 s, 10 each leg, 3 times a day
4	A walk to the end of the road	Once or twice a day
Then	Restart the plan two weeks earlier than you left it	

The Stairs

Up	Better leg first ("up with the good"); rail; whole foot on the step; push through the heel
Down	Worse leg first ("down with the bad"); rail; one step at a time if it hurts; sideways with both hands on the rail on a bad day
The training	Step-up and step-down three times a week; sit to stand daily